Camila Isabel Aguirre Díaz

Development economics | Applied microeconomics | Causal inference



Contact

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Research interests: Behavioural and environmental economics; Migration; Agricultural economics.

Research Experience

Aug 2024 – present

RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research, Essen – Germany
Department of Climate and Development Policy – Research project: Senegal Migration Panel
Since Jan 2026: Research Assistant (Wissenschaftliche Hilfskraft)

- Assess the impact of climate variability on migration in rural Senegal using linear probability models and difference-in-differences; the study estimates a 7.6 percentage-point reduction in the probability of migrating.
- Develop and validate climate-shock indicators for 143 villages and evaluate the effect of "false starts" (dry spells after the first rains of the sowing season) on household migration.
- Conduct robustness analyses with alternative climate-shock definitions, precipitation datasets and model specifications to test the sensitivity of the estimates.
- Create maps and visualisations in R and Stata of spatial patterns of climate exposure and migration.

Aug 2024 – Dec 2025: Research Assistant (Wissenschaftliche Hilfskraft), alongside M.A. studies

- Co-designed and implemented a panel survey of 4,600 rural households (questionnaire development, pretesting, field monitoring, interviewer training).
- Programmed automated data validation, cleaning and monitoring, reducing manual work and the error rate by 70%.
- Quality-checked and improved 800+ questions across three survey instruments.
- Conducted independent research comparing farmers' climate perceptions with observed data (fixed-effects LPM, Spearman correlation, trend tests), finding no convergence.
- Structured data from 447 studies and created network visualisations for an RWI working paper.

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Student Research Assistant – Faculty of Economics and Business Administration
Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito – Ecuador
Research project: Sources of the reproduction of inequalities in Ecuador

- Conducted literature reviews and quantitative analyses of census microdata on welfare programmes, social security benefits and social mobility.

Education

Oct 2023 – Nov 2025

M.A. Development Studies (Economics), University of Passau, Passau

- Final grade: Good (2.2).
- Master's thesis: Climate variability and agricultural conditions in Senegal: a critical comparison of farmers' local weather perceptions and real weather data.

Oct 2020 – Feb 2022

Master's Degree in Economic Analysis, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (UOC), Barcelona

- Final grade: Good (8.9/10), ranked 6th out of 33 graduates in the class.
- Master's thesis: Analysis of the Dynamics and Structure of the Ecuadorian Labour Market during the Period 2007–2019.

Oct 2014 – Mar 2019

Double Bachelor's Degree in Economics / Economics and Management, Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador, Quito / Université Grenoble Alpes, France

- Final grade: Very Good (9.0/10), ranked 4th out of 22 graduates in the class.
- Bachelor's thesis: Effect of relative income on women's health status globally, during the years 2000–2015.

Publications

- National Institute of Statistics and Censuses of Ecuador (2020). Methodology of the national survey on family relationships and gender-based violence against women. Co-author.

Contributions to Research Papers

- **Climate data preparation and empirical analysis for**: Haveresch, Sievert & Sall (2026). "False Starts, Fewer Departures: Early-Season Dry Spells and Migration in Rural Senegal", RWI Working Paper.
- **Literature review and network visualisation for**: Haveresch, Ankel-Peters & Bensch (2025). "A Slippery Slope: Topographic Variation as an Instrumental Variable", RWI Working Paper.

- **Literature review and census data analysis for**: Granda Benítez (2017–2018). “The Influence of the Economic Crisis of the 1980s on Inequality of Opportunity in Primary and Secondary Education in Ecuador”, PUCE.
- **Technical contribution (Strategies section) to**: United Nations (2022). “Guidelines on Quality Assurance Frameworks for Statistical Processes and Outputs”.

Awards and Scholarships

2023–2025	DAAD Helmut Schmidt Programme, Public Policy and Good Governance, 10 selected out of 800 applicants.
2020–2022	SENESCYT “Common Globe” Scholarship.

Teaching Experience

Apr 2019 – Apr 2020 **Academic Coordinator and Lecturer in Mathematics (part-time)**, Advanced Studies Centre (CEAV), Quito

Professional Experience

May 2021 – Mar 2023 **Senior Statistical Analyst (Team Lead) – Department of Statistical Quality**
National Institute of Statistics and Censuses, Quito – Ecuador

- Led an eight-person team developing 200+ quality indicators for 33 national statistical operations, the first systematic monitoring framework for official statistics in Ecuador.
- Monitored the quality of Ecuador’s 2022 Census (16.9M inhabitants, 6.6M dwellings) to reduce measurement error and bias.
- Managed quality certification and monitoring tools for national surveys in line with international standards, including the quarterly employment survey.
- Represented the statistics office at the UN Statistics Division and ECLAC, and contributed to a regional data-quality guide.
- Developed indicators disaggregated by gender and social group for government planning and SDG monitoring.

Apr 2019 – Apr 2021 **Junior Statistical Analyst – Department of Statistical Planning**
National Institute of Statistics and Censuses, Quito – Ecuador

- Coordinated with external institutions to develop indicators for national and international development frameworks.
- Assessed information needs across 110 surveys, censuses and administrative sources to identify data gaps for national planning.
- Advised internal projects on methodology and quality assurance to standardise data production processes in national surveys and administrative records.
- Contributed to national gender-statistics initiatives (questionnaire design, methodology, indicators, quality assurance).

Methods and Technical Skills

Quantitative methods and causal inference: experimental and quasi-experimental designs; difference-in-differences (DiD); panel, time series and cross-sectional data analysis; generalised linear models; Markov chains; robustness and sensitivity analysis; cluster analysis; PCA; bootstrapping.
Data and survey analysis: production of large-scale datasets (household, administrative and census data); field monitoring; automated cleaning; geo-referenced and climate data; quality assurance (UN-NQAF/ISO).
Statistical programming: R, Stata, SPSS (very good); Python (good); oTree (currently learning).
Data collection and visualisation: SurveyCTO, KoboToolbox, Power BI, Gephi (very good); Apify (web scraping) (good).
Data management and automation: Google Earth Engine, GitHub, n8n (good).

Languages

Spanish — native language English — C1 German — B2 French — B1

Language training: Professional German course (Berufssprachkurs), bfz Munich, Aug–Dec 2026 (ongoing).

Volunteer Work and Interests

Nov 2026 – present	**Scuba diving**: PADI Open Water Diver certification.
Nov 2020 – Feb 2024	**Youth Representative**, Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN) Andes, covering seven countries (Argentina, Bolivia, Chile, Colombia, Ecuador, Peru, Venezuela).
Oct 2014 – Mar 2023	**Hiking and trekking**: Member of the Hiking Club, Pontifical Catholic University of Ecuador (PUCE).

Note: *Additional training, certifications and code samples are available on the website.*

Munich, 2 November 2026



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